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Portugal needs to claim the southern half of the African continent to preserve its territories, increase wealth, and to prevent another national humiliation from happening. Because Portugal is a small country in the Iberian Peninsula, it is in its best interest to maintain and preserve its territory by expanding its sphere of influence across the southern half of the continent. In addition, Portugal's limited colonies across the world means that Portuguese colonies are generating less profit and revenue relative to Spanish, French, and British colonies. Not only that, Portugal needs to learn from its lesson that it faced after the 1890 British Ultimatum resulted in Portuguese claims being revoked by the British.

Portugal has one of the long histories of colonization alongside Spain following the ratification of the Treaty of Tordesillas in 1494. The terms of the Treaty of Tordesillas meant that Portugal was to colonize all lands that it discovered east of the Line of Demarcation that ran through the easternmost parts of Brazil. Because of this, Portugal claimed Brazil, which was one of Portugal's largest colonies. In addition, Portuguese colonies included Guinea, Angola, Mozambique, Mombasa, Malacca, Macau, and trading posts along the western coast of India. As of 1890, Portugal has lost control of Brazil, Malacca, Macau, and trading posts such as Goa, Cochin, and Calicut either because of independence or other European countries took over Portuguese possessions.

Because of the 1890 British Ultimatum, Britain is Portugal's biggest rival because the British revoked all Portuguese claims to Zambia, Zimbabwe, and Malawi. Having access to the African interior between Angola and Mozambique will greatly benefit the Portuguese economy to make up for the losses that the Portuguese Empire went through, especially after losing control of Brazil, the Malaccas, Macau, and trading posts in India. In addition, Portugal should expand control to the southernmost tip of Africa to further benefit the Portuguese economy. Not only will Portuguese control over the southernmost tip of Africa will benefit its economy, it will also allow Portuguese culture to spread and not be at risk of being lost forever. Lastly, Portugal needs to learn from its lesson that it learned the hard way by increasing the size of its armed forces to prevent a repeat of the 1890 British Ultimatum. Having a stronger military for Portugal will allow Portugal to stand up to any demands made by any country that would mean the loss of Portuguese control over its colonies. In addition, a strong military force will deter other countries from issuing demands that would lead to another repeat of the 1890 British Ultimatum and to be able to expand increase Portugal's wealth by getting more profit and revenue off its African colonies.